

EDISON LAW

PRIVATE PROSECUTIONS · ASSET RECOVERY · FINANCIAL CRIME

CLIENT AUTHORITY AND CONSENT FORM

Authority to act and investigate

If you have lost money to a fraud or a scam, this form appoints Edison Law to investigate what happened and to try to recover your money. Please complete every section you can. If you do not know something, write "not known" rather than guessing — an honest gap is more useful to us than a wrong answer.

OUR FEE IN ONE SENTENCE

If we recover money for you, you pay us **20% of what is recovered**, once — and nothing else. If we recover nothing, you pay us nothing. There is no hourly charge, no upfront payment, and no bill to settle while the work is going on.

PLEASE READ THIS — IT PROTECTS YOU

People who have been defrauded are very often approached a second time by someone offering to get their money back. Those approaches are usually part of the same fraud. Edison Law will **never** ask you to pay a fee in advance, to send money to release a recovery, or to pay tax, insurance or a release charge on funds. Our bank details will never change during your matter, and we will never tell you they have changed by email. If anyone contacts you claiming to be from this firm and asks for money, stop and telephone us on a number you have found independently.

Edison Law is authorised and regulated by the Solicitors Regulation Authority, SRA number [\[510498 — verify\]](#). This form, once signed by you and countersigned by us, is a non-contentious business agreement for the purposes of section 57 of the Solicitors Act 1974.

PART 1

ABOUT YOU

FULL LEGAL NAME	
DATE OF BIRTH	
TELEPHONE	
OCCUPATION	

PART 2

YOUR AUTHORITY TO US

By signing this form I appoint Edison Law to act for me, and I authorise the firm:

1. to investigate the fraud or scam of which I have been a victim, as I have described it to the firm, to establish what happened to my money and where it went, and to advise me on the options for recovering it;
2. to obtain, from any bank, building society, payment institution, e-money institution, cryptoasset exchange, credit reference agency, telecommunications provider, online platform, regulator or ombudsman scheme, all records relating to me, to my accounts, and to the payments I have described to the firm — and to make any subject access request in my name for that purpose;
3. to correspond and negotiate on my behalf with any of those bodies, with the police and Action Fraud, and with any person identified as having received my money, including making formal demand for its return;
4. to make, pursue, and where appropriate settle, any complaint, chargeback claim, reimbursement claim or ombudsman complaint on my behalf;
5. to instruct forensic accountants, tracing agents, blockchain analysts, counsel or other experts where the firm considers it necessary;
6. to receive money recovered on my behalf into the firm's client account, and to deduct the firm's fee under Part 3 before accounting to me for the balance; and
7. to accept a copy, scan or electronic image of this authority as if it were the original.

This authority continues until I revoke it in writing.

PART 3 OUR FEE

8. **Twenty per cent of what we recover, once.** If the matter results in a recovery, our fee is **20% of the Recovered Amount**, [plus / including] VAT. It is a single, one-off charge. There is nothing else to pay: our professional charges and the cost of any expert, search, agent or counsel we instruct are all covered by it.
9. **If we recover nothing, you pay nothing.** There is no hourly rate, no upfront payment, and no bill while the work is going on.
10. **What counts as recovered.** The **Recovered Amount** is the gross value, before any deduction, of any money or asset you receive, or which is credited, refunded, reimbursed or restored to you, or any liability of yours that is

written off or reduced, arising directly or indirectly from our work — whether paid by the fraudster, a bank, a payment provider, an exchange, an insurer, an ombudsman award, a reimbursement scheme, or anyone else.

11. **When it is payable.** Our fee falls due when the recovered money is received. Where it is received into our client account, you authorise us to deduct our fee and pay you the balance, and we will send you a bill and a written statement of the deduction at the same time.
12. **If money arrives after we finish.** If, within 12 months of this agreement ending, you receive money arising from work we did or from a claim or counterparty we identified, our fee is still payable on it. This does not apply if we stopped acting without good reason.
13. **Tell us if you are paid directly.** If anyone pays you, or credits your account, in connection with this matter, please tell us promptly — whether or not you think it is connected to our work.
14. This is a non-contentious business agreement under section 57 of the Solicitors Act 1974. You may ask the court to set it aside if the court thinks it unfair or unreasonable.

IF THE MATTER GOES TO COURT

This agreement covers investigation and negotiation. It does not cover issuing court proceedings. If proceedings become the right step we will explain that to you and agree separate written terms with you **before** anything is issued. You will never be committed to litigation by signing this form.

TERMS YOU SHOULD KNOW ABOUT

What we will do, and what we cannot promise

We will investigate diligently and keep you informed, reporting to you at least every [\[six weeks\]](#) and promptly on anything significant. We cannot promise a recovery. Money lost to fraud is often moved quickly and beyond reach, and some matters end with no recovery at all despite everything being done properly.

What we need from you

- Tell us everything relevant, including anything that is embarrassing or unhelpful to your case. We will rely on what you tell us.
- Give us documents promptly when we ask.
- Do not contact anyone we identify as a suspected recipient of your money, and do not accept any settlement offer, without speaking to us first.

Identity checks

The law requires us to verify your identity before we begin substantive work, which may include an electronic check. We cannot start until that is done.

Reporting obligations

We have duties under the Proceeds of Crime Act 2002. In some circumstances we may have to report a matter to the National Crime Agency, and the law may prevent us from telling you we have done so, or require us to pause. We will not be liable for loss caused by complying with those duties.

Your information

We are the controller of your personal data and process it to act for you, to meet our legal obligations, and for our legitimate interest in investigating and recovering assets. Our privacy notice is at [\[edisonlaw.uk/privacy\]](#).

Our liability and insurance

We carry professional indemnity insurance meeting the SRA's minimum terms; details are available on request. Our total liability on this matter is limited to [\[£3,000,000\]](#). That limit does not apply to death or personal injury caused by our negligence, to fraud, or to anything that cannot lawfully be limited.

Ending the agreement

You may end it at any time in writing and will owe us nothing for our time. We may stop acting only for good reason and on reasonable notice — for example if you do not give instructions, ask us to act improperly, or if it becomes clear there is no realistic prospect of a recovery.

Your right to cancel

You may cancel within **14 days** of the day after this agreement is made, without giving a reason and at no cost. Write to us at [\[address / email\]](#) — any clear statement will do. We will not start work during those 14 days unless you tick the box in Part 5 asking us to.

Complaints

Please raise any concern first with the person handling your matter, and then with our Complaints Partner, [\[name\]](#), at [\[email\]](#). We will acknowledge within [\[5\]](#) working days and respond substantively within [\[8\]](#) weeks. If we do not resolve it, you may take it to the Legal Ombudsman — normally within **six months** of our final response, **and** within **one year** of

the problem or of when you should reasonably have known about it. Legal Ombudsman, PO Box 6167, Slough SL1 0EH · 0300 555 0333 · enquiries@legalombudsman.org.uk. You may also report a regulatory concern to the Solicitors Regulation Authority at sra.org.uk.

Law

This agreement is governed by the law of England and Wales, and the courts of England and Wales have exclusive jurisdiction.

DECLARATION AND SIGNATURE

I confirm that:

- the information I have given in this form is true to the best of my knowledge and belief;
- I have read and I accept Parts 2, 3 and 4, and I understand that if money is recovered I will pay Edison Law 20% of it as a single fee;
- I understand that if nothing is recovered I pay nothing;
- I understand this agreement does not cover court proceedings, and that separate terms would be agreed with me first; and
- I have had the chance to ask questions and to take independent advice.

SIGNED — CLIENT

PRINT NAME

DATE

SIGNED FOR AND ON BEHALF OF EDISON LAW

☐ **Start now (optional).** Tick and initial only if you want us to begin before your 14-day cancellation period ends. If you then cancel within the 14 days, you would pay a reasonable amount for work already done. Initials []

Joint claims

If the money was lost from a joint account, or more than one person is making the claim, each person must sign their own copy of this form.

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